

Criminal-Defense Checklist Web Application

Quick Start

1. **Open checklist-app.html in your web browser** (double-click the file)
2. The template loads automatically from `CriminalDefenseChecklist.md` (or click "**Load Template**" and select it)
3. **Click "New Client"** to create your first checklist
4. Start checking off items!

Features

✓ **Template-Driven**

- The checklist structure comes from `CriminalDefenseChecklist.md`
- Edit the Markdown file to modify the template (add/remove items)
- Reload the template in the app to see changes; existing clients keep the template they were created with

✓ **Per-Client Instances**

- Create unlimited client checklists
- Each client has independent state
- Progress tracked per client

✓ **Smart Checkboxes**

- Parent items auto-complete when all children are checked
- Progress indicators show completion percentage
- Visual feedback for completed items

✓ **Data Management**

- Auto-saves to browser localStorage
- **Export All** - Backup all clients in one file (recommended weekly)
- **Import All** - Restore all clients from backup
- **Optional Password Encryption** - Encrypt backups with AES-256
- Export or import individual client data as JSON
- Delete/archive old cases

✓ Search & Navigate

- Search box to filter items
- Collapsible sections (click ▼ to collapse)
- Paginated and single-page view modes

✓ Print Support

- Print-friendly formatting for checklists
- **Printable Forms** - Click "Print Form" on any form section to generate a fillable page: underscored fields become fillable lines, client info is pre-filled, and the browser's print dialog saves it as PDF

How to Modify the Template

The template file (`CriminalDefenseChecklist.md`) is ordinary Markdown:

Format Rules

- **## Heading** = a top-level section
- **- [] Item** = a checklist item; nest deeper levels by indenting two more spaces
- **_ at end of line** = fillable field (e.g., `- [ ] Phone_`)
- *** at end of line** = keep this item's sublist on the same printed page
- **- *Note:* text** = explanatory note (displayed, but no checkbox)
- **```form ... ```** fenced block = an intake form, kept together on one page
- **<!-- comment -->** = ignored entirely

Example

```
## Main Section
- [ ] Subsection
- [ ] Another Subsection
  - [ ] Detail item
  - [ ] Name_
  - *Note:* This is a helpful note
    ```form
 Form content here
 Line 1_
 Line 2_
    ```
```

To Edit

1. Open `CriminalDefenseChecklist.md` in any text editor (or edit it on GitHub)
2. Make your changes and save
3. Run `python3 scripts/validate_md.py` to confirm the structure is sound
4. In the web app, click "Load Template" again
5. New clients will use the updated template

Data Storage

Where is data stored?

- **Browser localStorage** (automatic, no setup needed)
- **Your computer only** (not sent anywhere)
- Data persists between sessions
- Each browser keeps separate storage; use Export/Import to move between browsers

⚠ **IMPORTANT: Backup Your Data Regularly**

Browser localStorage can be cleared by cache clearing, browser updates or crashes, switching browsers, or computer issues.

Option 1: Export All (recommended) 1. Click " **Export All**" in the header 2. Save the backup file (`all_clients_backup_YYYY-MM-DD.json`) 3. Store it somewhere safe (cloud storage, external drive) 4. Repeat weekly or after significant updates

Option 2: Export individual clients with the "Export" button on each client card.

To restore: " Import All" replaces all current data from a full backup; " Import Client" adds one client from an individual file.

Password Encryption (Optional)

When exporting, the app offers to encrypt the backup:

- AES-256-GCM encryption with PBKDF2 key derivation (100,000 iterations), random salt and IV per backup
- Minimum 8-character password; the filename gains an `_ENCRYPTED` marker
- Importing an encrypted file prompts for the password automatically

⚠ **CRITICAL: There is no password recovery. A lost password means an unrecoverable backup.**

Use encryption whenever a backup lands in cloud storage, email, or any place an unauthorized person might reach it.

Troubleshooting

"Template not loading"

- Make sure you selected `CriminalDefenseChecklist.md` (the app also still reads the old tab-indented `.txt` format)
- Open the file in a text editor to verify it is readable
- Run `python3 scripts/validate_md.py` to check for structural problems

"My clients disappeared"

- Check that you are using the same browser
- Import from your backup `.json` files
- A cleared browser cache deletes `localStorage` — keep backups

"Items won't check"

- Refresh the page
- Check the browser console for errors (F12)
- Export and re-import the client

Tips

- **Keyboard shortcut:** Ctrl/Cmd + S saves the current checklist
- **Collapse sections** you are not working on
- **Use Search** to find specific items quickly
- **Export regularly** ("Export All" weekly)
- **Print to PDF** for permanent records
- **Clear Storage** when using shared computers
- **Use encryption** for backups stored in cloud services

System Requirements

- Any modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge) on any platform
- Works offline; no installation, no server

Privacy

- All data stays in your browser

- Nothing is sent to any server
- No tracking or analytics